

Answer Key

Grade 5 Intermediate Passages

1. One Variable

1. What problem does the partner's plan create?
A. Two changes at once would make the cause unclear.
2. What do they agree to keep the same?
B. The pots, the light, and the water
3. Why can they claim the food caused the growth?
A. It was the only difference between the two cups.

2. The Axis

1. What is the conflict in Noah's project?
C. His conclusion says the opposite of what the graph shows.
2. Why is his first conclusion wrong?
D. He described the result he hoped for, not the taller bars.
3. What makes the revised conclusion stronger?
D. A reader can check it against the graph.

3. Before It Is Sent

1. What is weak about Jade's first email?
C. It accuses the custodian instead of stating a clear request.
2. What does Jade keep when she revises?
C. The facts about where the bins are and when they fill up
3. Why does the second draft work better?
D. It asks for a pickup and offers help without blaming anyone.

4. Half the Lights

1. What happens when all eight lights are on?
B. The breaker trips and the stage goes dark.
2. How does Diego find a load the circuit can carry?
B. He adds lights one at a time until the breaker hums.
3. What tradeoff does he accept?
C. A dimmer stage is better than no light at all.

5. The Wrong Address

1. What is wrong with the petition?
A. It names Fifth and Oak instead of Fifth and Elm.
2. Why doesn't Sofia just cross out the old address?
A. A marked-up petition can look unofficial.
3. How does she make the petition usable?
B. She prints a corrected page and asks people to sign again.

6. What the Budget Can Carry

1. Why is cutting the bus a poor solution?
A. Some students would be left out if families had to drive.
2. What do they cut instead?
A. The decorations, which do not decide who can go
3. What does the revised budget protect?
C. A seat on the bus for every student

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7. Not Everyone

1. What is overstated in Noor's first draft?
C. She says the whole school wants something only her class voted on.
2. How does she make the claim match the evidence?
A. She names her class and the number of votes.
3. What does the crossed-out draft remind her?
A. A bigger claim needs a bigger survey.

8. Swapped Wires

1. What does the car do wrong?
D. It drives away from the line it should follow.
2. Why doesn't Leo rewrite the program first?
B. The same program worked before the car was rebuilt.
3. What single change fixes the car?
D. He swaps the two sensor wires.

9. Two Dates

1. What problem does Felix find in his research?
A. Two sources give different years for the library opening.
2. Why does he trust the book more than the website?
D. The book is the assigned reference and shows where the date comes from.
3. What does the note at the end accomplish?
D. It shows the conflict instead of hiding it.

10. The Buzz in the Take

1. What is wrong with the recording?
B. A phone against the speaker adds a buzz to one song.
2. Why don't they rerecord the entire concert?
C. Only the third song is damaged, and the opening of it is clean.
3. What does Nina's file label protect?
C. The edit that joins the clean opening to the new section

11. Double the Salt

1. Why is the first pot too salty?
B. Sam multiplied the salt by the same number as the water.
2. What does he do with the salty broth?
A. He saves it for a bean dish and starts a second pot.
3. What rule does he add to the card?
B. Scaling a recipe is not the same as multiplying every line.

12. One Square Off

1. What is wrong with the mural?
C. The tree is one square left of where the sketch places it.
2. Why do they wipe the tree instead of painting over it later?
D. The paint is still wet, so it can come off the primer.
3. What starting point fixes the grid?
D. Measuring from the doorway outward

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13. More Than Praise

1. What is missing from Andre's first review?
C. A specific suggestion Lila can use
2. What strength does he name the second time?
C. The opening that puts the reader in the rain
3. How does Lila use his suggestion?
B. She keeps the solution and adds the moment of choosing.

14. The Missing Hour

1. What is dishonest about the smooth line?
D. It pretends there was a 2:00 reading when the log has none.
2. How does Mei show the gap?
D. She breaks the line and writes no reading under that hour.
3. Why is the break more scientific than a pretty line?
A. It shows what was measured and what was not.

15. Two Lines Too Many

1. Why is the scene too long?
B. Two speeches repeat the same fact about the key.
2. What does Camila refuse to cut?
D. The moment when the character decides
3. What does the timed reading show?
C. The scene fits the slot once the echo is gone.

16. Three Steps on the Door

1. Why do found items sit unclaimed?
C. The office often does not know what they are or where they were found.
2. What three facts does the form ask for?
A. What it is, where it was found, and the date
3. How does the water bottle show that the form works?
B. The owner finds it the same day because the place and day are written down.

17. The Long Intro

1. What is out of balance in the first episode?
B. Priya's introduction is longer than the interview.
2. What does Priya cut?
C. Her own opening, not the guest's interview
3. How does she know the new cut works?
C. Classmates can retell the guest's point after one listen.

18. The Scale Bar

1. What is misleading about Rosa's first map?
C. The park and the school look the same size, but they are not.
2. How does she decide the park's new size?
B. She compares both places on the same printout.
3. What does the classmate's walk test show?
A. The scale bar predicts the time closely enough to trust.

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19. One Crowded Hour

1. What is wrong with the first signup?
B. Everyone chose the same hour, so the rest of the day is empty.
2. How does Hector fill the empty hours?
D. He asks for second choices and moves some students.
3. What does the Saturday result show?
B. The work lasts through noon because the hours are spread out.

20. Free Means Paid For

1. Why is the word free a problem?
B. The council cannot afford the pizza the poster promises.
2. What change makes the poster honest?
B. It lists a one-dollar price that covers the food.
3. Why does Ivy keep both files?
A. They show the difference between an exciting line and a promise she can keep.

21. Not a Quote

1. What is unfair about the first version of the article?
D. It names a classmate who never agreed to be quoted.
2. How does she keep the point without the quote?
D. She reports the idea in her own words and leaves the name off.
3. What rule does she add to her checklist?
A. Do not name or quote someone who has not agreed.

22. A Fan Instead of Force

1. Why shouldn't the group force the window?
D. The glass could crack and cool the greenhouse at night.
2. How do they move air without opening the window?
A. They run a fan on low, aimed across the bench.
3. Why does Owen still write a work order?
D. The fan is a temporary fix, not a repaired window.

23. A Way to Stop

1. What is wrong with Theo's loop?
A. It repeats the names and never checks for the end.
2. What does he do before he changes the code?
A. He saves the file so unplugging the computer is unnecessary.
3. How does the new condition work?
D. The loop stops when the next line is blank.

24. The Front Row Twice

1. What conflict is built into the seating form?
D. It lets two classes both claim the front row.
2. Why can't Jordan simply give the front row to one class?
B. Neither class fits in fourteen chairs for the whole event, and both were told yes.
3. What does the revised plan do?
C. The classes trade the front row at the break.

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25. In Her Own Words

1. What is the problem with Elena's favorite sentence?
D. It copies the book's wording, not just the fact.
2. How does she rewrite it?
C. She closes the book and states the fact in her own sentence.
3. Why does the book stay on the source list?
B. The fact came from the book even after the words changed.

26. A Team Twice in a Row

1. What is unfair about the first bracket?
B. One team plays twice before another team plays at all.
2. What rule does Malik use when he redraws it?
A. Every team appears once before any team appears twice.
3. Why can he change the bracket without taking a win away?
B. No games have been played yet.

27. A Question the Chapter Can Answer

1. Why doesn't Amina's first question work?
D. The chapter ends before the forgiveness she asks about.
2. What does the chapter actually show?
C. The character decides to return the book, and it gives a reason.
3. How does the group handle the forgiveness idea?
A. They may call it a prediction, not a fact from the chapter.

28. Where the Fair Should Stand

1. What decision is the committee facing?
A. Whether to risk rain on the lawn or accept fewer tables indoors
2. How does Ben use the survey?
B. He reports both numbers and explains the cost of wet books.
3. Why does he post the tally?
A. So the volunteers who disagreed can see they were counted

29. What the Caption Can Claim

1. What is the difference between the two claims?
A. Oldest ever is bigger than anything the loan card supports.
2. Why does Omar drop the dramatic sentence from the caption?
B. Nothing on the table is a source for that claim.
3. What does he do with the bigger idea instead?
B. He turns it into a question for the audience.

30. The Trial That Disagreed

1. Why is averaging 80 and 65 a bad idea?
A. It would create a distance neither notebook actually measured.
2. What do they agree on before they rerun the trial?
C. Where to measure the car, and who reads the tape
3. Why are the crossed-out numbers still useful?
C. They show the group noticed a conflict instead of hiding it.